Sujet : RE: Permission request: Redistribution of subset derived from WDPA for Madagascar (Academic non-commercial use)
De : Jasmin Upton <Jasmin.Upton@unep-wcmc.org>
Date : 18/05/2026, 16:08
Pour : Florent Bedecarrats <florent.bedecarrats@ird.fr>, protectedareas <protectedareas@unep-wcmc.org>
Copie à : Seheno RAMANANTSOA <ramanantsoa_seheno@yahoo.com>, Ollier Duranton ANDRIANAMBININA <ollier_cdcsi@mnparks.mg>

Dear Florent,

Thank you for your email.

One reason we generally do not allow redistribution of the WDCPA is that older versions of the dataset can continue circulating, which creates a risk of people relying on outdated information. That said, we are happy for you to redistribute Madagascar's data for this specific use case, as long as it is only the WDPCA data for Madagascar. We would, however, kindly request that you include a clear statement on DataSuds stating that the dataset represents an older version of the data, and direct users to Protected Planet to access the latest data (https://www.protectedplanet.net).

We agree that communicating trends in protected and conserved area boundaries is important, and we have been working on a similar initiative at the global level. In particular, we are developing a data management portal that will function on the back end of the Protected Planet website, where users will be able to access all historical versions of the WDCPA on a global scale.

Best,

Jasmin

From: Florent Bedecarrats <florent.bedecarrats@ird.fr>
Sent: 15 May 2026 07:55
To: Jasmin Upton <Jasmin.Upton@unep-wcmc.org>; protectedareas <protectedareas@unep-wcmc.org>
Cc: Seheno RAMANANTSOA <ramanantsoa_seheno@yahoo.com>; Ollier Duranton ANDRIANAMBININA <ollier_cdcsi@mnparks.mg>
Subject: Permission request: Redistribution of subset derived from WDPA for Madagascar (Academic non-commercial use)

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Dear UNEP-WCMC protected areas team,

We are writing to formally request written permission to redistribute a derived, non-commercial dataset based on the World Database on Protected Areas (WDPA), under the terms defined in the WDPA Data License.

We are a team of researchers and conservation practitioners affiliated with the French National Research Institute for Sustainable Development (IRD), the Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development of Madagascar (MEDD), and Madagascar National Parks (MNP). We have reconstructed the temporal and historical spatial boundaries of 123 terrestrial protected areas in Madagascar (spanning 2000–2025). Because the WDPA is designed as a snapshot database, it overwrites historical boundaries and status when updates occur. However, accurately describing conservation trends and rigorously evaluating

impact implies having an accurate reconstitution of past spatial configurations. Our dataset provides this context by preserving the history of boundary modifications and internal zoning.

To achieve this, we developed a temporal extension model that corrects and extends the WDPA baseline. The open-source workflow (fully documented at https://betsaka.github.io/conservation-dynamic-madagascar/) operates using two main components:
1. An amendment registry: All boundary modifications, status changes, and internal zoning additions (such as core zones) are precisely documented in YAML files. We chose YAML because it is human-readable, auditable, and suited for version control (Git), allowing researchers to track the exact legal sources and dates of every change. Where geometries are modified relative to the WDPA, they are provided alongside as GeoJSON files. This open registry is permanently deposited on the DataSuds repository (https://doi.org/10.23708/VN2TWC).
2. Consolidation rules: We provide a deterministic set of formatting rules implemented in R that explicitly merge this amendment registry with the standard WDPA baseline to generate a finalized geospatial dataset.

We have submitted a Data Descriptor manuscript detailing this dataset to the journal *Scientific Data* (https://www.nature.com/sdata). A preprint of our manuscript is available here: https://hal.science/hal-05607537. While our open-source R scripts allow anyone to dynamically re-generate and regularly update the data against their own WDPA downloads, we also wish to host a pre-compiled "snapshot" of the dataset based on the November 2025 WDPA release in GeoPackage (.gpkg) and GeoParquet (.parquet) formats. Although the dataset is specifically designed to be reproduced dynamically, providing these pre-compiled files "as such" would be crucial to help users immediately understand the content, the schema, and the immense analytical interest of the temporal data.

Because our pre-compiled GeoPackage and GeoParquet files integrate and republish geometries and attributes from the WDPA baseline, we understand the WDPA licensing terms restrict redistribution of derivative works without prior approval. We seek your explicit permission to publicly distribute these compiled structural files on the IRD's institutional data repository (DataSuds) under a non-commercial open data license (e.g., CC-BY-NC 4.0). Our dataset will clearly and explicitly attribute UNEP-WCMC as the baseline source in compliance with your citation requirements.

You can find the corresponding yaml, gpkg and parquet files at: https://drive.ird.fr/s/cqo3bZr8RSA2LAM (this link is only communicated to you and to the journal reviewers).

Could you kindly confirm if we are permitted to host our derived compiled dataset on our institutional repository? If there are specific licensing restrictions or attribution clauses you require us to attach to the dataset, please let us know so we can implement them exactly as specified.

Thank you very much for your time and for maintaining this invaluable resource for the conservation community.

Best regards,

Florent Bédécarrats (IRD), Seheno Ramanantsoa (MEDD), and Ollier D. Andrianambinina (MNP)